Email Scripts for Students

Templates for professors, advisors, landlords.

A TOOLKIT FOR REQUESTS, EXPLANATIONS AND FOLLOW-UPS

01 The condition

The email that needs sending is often the heaviest thing on the list. Not because it is complicated, but because it has been waiting, and every day it waits it gets harder to start.

When it finally goes out, it tends to over-explain: three paragraphs of apology and history before the actual request. A professor reading forty messages a day needs four things. What you are asking for. Briefly why. What you can do instead. How to reply.

02 How to use this sample

Copy the script on the next page into a new email. Fill the brackets. Read it once, then send it. Don’t rewrite it into something longer.

If your school has a disability or accessibility office, a formal accommodation may protect you better than a one-off request. Both are allowed.

03 The extension request

COPY, FILL, SEND

Subject: Extension request: [course code], [assignment]

Dear Professor [name],

I’m writing to ask for an extension on [assignment], currently due [date]. [One sentence of reason. You don’t owe the full story.]

I can submit it by [new date]. If that doesn’t work, could we find a date that does?

Thank you,
[your name] · [student ID]

04 What to leave out

— A full medical or personal history
— Apologies for the request itself
— Promises you can’t measure (“I’ll work much harder”)

AFTER A WEEK OF SILENCE

“Following up on my message from [date] about [assignment]. Could you let me know whether [new date] works?”

THE FULL TOOLKIT

This is a two-page sample of *Email Scripts for Students*, a 11-page toolkit. The full version also holds:

— Missed-class notices and returning after an absence
— Advising questions, and roommate and landlord messages
— Follow-ups after silence, and how to escalate politely

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